

What happens when you stop defending your function and start scaling someone else's good idea?

The best learning solution didn't come from Learning. My job was to recognize it, make it scalable, and connect it to performance.

Enterprise Scale

Business Results

Transformation Experience



A District Manager had an idea.

He was using simple, paper quizzes with his team to test their product knowledge - and it was working.



I saw something work scaling.

It was driving sales, but couldn't work in the manual format. It needed refinement.



We built it for the field

I created a product quiz for a newly launched product that had almost no sales. I curated content to educate, digitized the quiz, and worked with leaders and trainers to get it into the field. We spent that Friday morning training the region, and the rest of the weekend side-by-side coaching.



And then we ran out of product.

Our region sold more of the product than all 7 other regions combined. The warehouse GM called the Region VP to ask what happened.

Sales leaders cheered. Learning leaders didn't.

The head of Curriculum wasn't thrilled that I'd 'built something' instead of using their material. Fair. I stayed factual. And I explained: I didn't really create it. I curated it.



The resources already existed. What was missing was the narrative connecting them and the mechanism showing people how to use them.

That conversation ultimately opened a door for me to work more closely with Curriculum and influence how materials were created.

AT A GLANCE



5,500 regional employees



1 field idea turned into a campaign



3 days of targeted effort



Outsold the combined national results

WHY THIS STORY

This story catches me learning an important leadership lesson in real time. I didn't immediately recognize the value of an idea that came from outside my function — but once I did, I helped make it much bigger.

This story also demonstrates:

Field listening

Rapid experimentation

Cross-functional leadership

Commercial acumen

Influence without authority

IF WE TALK, ASK ME ABOUT

- Why the District Manager's idea made me uncomfortable.
- What I changed - and didn't change - about the DM's original approach.
- How we connected the sales spike to learning.
- The tools I used to grass-roots an enterprise-sized experience.
- What my VP said when we received national attention.
- How my partnership with local leaders changed after the campaign.

WHAT I'M PROUD OF

I turned a quiz into a business lever. We didn't stop at knowledge. We found the way to connect learning to action, and the results spoke for themselves. Just as validating was seeing the strength of the partnership I'd built when my VP came to my defense.

MY GUIDING PRINCIPLE

Great leadership makes good ideas bigger. I don't need to be the source of an idea to recognize its value, strengthen it, and help it scale.

IF I HAD A DO-OVER

I'd look for the potential before the flaws. I initially resisted the idea because it didn't come from Learning. I'd focus sooner on what was working, scale its strengths, and bring Curriculum in earlier to help.